

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 688

By Brooks

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of the victims of the Waffle House shooting in Nashville on the seventh anniversary of the tragedy.

WHEREAS, in the early morning hours of April 22, 2018, the patrons and employees of a Waffle House restaurant in the Antioch community were attacked, and four innocent people lost their lives; and

WHEREAS, Akilah Dasilva, DeEbony Groves, Joe Perez, and Taurean Sanderlin were fatally wounded during the tragic event; each of the four was under thirty years of age and had a long, bright future ahead; and

WHEREAS, a student at Middle Tennessee State University, where he was pursuing a degree in computer engineering, Akilah Dasilva was a "humble, kind, compassionate, outgoing, and very creative" young man who possessed "a zeal for life" and was "a selfless friend" and a beacon of hope; and

WHEREAS, formerly an exceptional student, star basketball player, and role model at Gallatin High School, DeEbony Groves attended Belmont University, where she impressed her peers and professors as a brilliant young woman with immense potential; and

WHEREAS, a native of Austin, Texas, Joe Perez worked as a subcontractor for a flood relocation and logistics company; he had attended Jack C. Hays High School and possessed a whimsical sense of humor; and

WHEREAS, a five-year employee of Waffle House who worked as a cook, Taurean Sanderlin of Goodlettsville was renowned for his work ethic; his friendly demeanor earned him the affection of the Antioch location's regular customers, who knew him as "T"; and

WHEREAS, sadly, these four fine young people were denied the opportunity to live and excel as contributing members of our society, and it is fitting that we express our respect and sorrow at the passing of Akilah Dasilva, DeEbony Groves, Joe Perez, and Taurean Sanderlin who live on in the hearts and minds of their family, friends, and fellow Nashvillians; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that, on the occasion of the seventh anniversary of the Waffle House Shooting on April 22, 2018, we honor the memories of Akilah Dasilva, DeEbony Groves, Joe Perez, and Taurean Sanderlin, four beloved members of the Nashville community who were taken from us too soon.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.